

Python - Positional-Only Arguments

Positional Only Arguments

It is possible in **Python** to define a **function** in which one or more arguments can not accept their value with keywords. Such arguments are called **positional-only arguments**.

To make an argument positional-only, use the forward slash (/) symbol. All the arguments before this symbol will be treated as positional-only.

Python's **built-in input()** function is an example of positional-only arguments. The syntax of input function is –

```
input(prompt = "")
```

Prompt is an explanatory string for the benefit of the user. However, you cannot use the prompt keyword inside the parentheses.

Example

In this example, we are using **prompt** keyword, which will lead to error.

```
name = input(prompt="Enter your name ")
```

On executing, this code will show the following error message –

```
name = input (prompt="Enter your name ")
^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^
```

TypeError: input() takes no keyword arguments

Positional-Only Arguments Examples

Let's understand positional-only arguments with the help of some examples –

Example 1

In this example, we make both the arguments of `intr()` **function** as positional-only by putting "/" at the end.

```
def intr(amt, rate, /):
    val = amt * rate / 100
    return val

print(intr(316200, 4))
```

When you run the code, it will show the following result –

12648.0

Example 2

If we try to use the arguments as keywords, Python raises errors as shown in the below example.

```
def intr(amt, rate, /):  
    val = amt * rate / 100  
    return val  
  
print(intr(amt=1000, rate=10))
```

On running this code, it will show following error message –

```
interest = intr(amt=1000, rate=10)
^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^
```

```
TypeError: intr() got some positional-only arguments passed as keyword arguments
```

Example 3

A function may be defined in such a way that it has some keyword-only and some positional-only arguments. Here, `x` is a required positional-only argument, `y` is a regular positional argument, and `z` is a keyword-only argument.

```
def myfunction(x, /, y, *, z):  
    print (x, y, z)  
  
myfunction(10, y=20, z=30)  
myfunction(10, 20, z=30)
```

The above code will show the following output –

10 20 30
10 20 30

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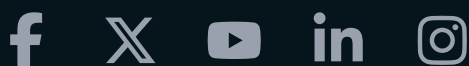
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